

Xbox

Fall of 2001 saw the release of one of the current giants of console gaming, and perhaps the only console that could topple the PS2—Microsoft's Xbox. Microsoft had been involved in gaming for some time, with games such as *Age Of Empires* and *Microsoft Flight Simulator*. So it wasn't really a huge surprise when Bill Gates announced that Microsoft would be releasing their own console. What was more interesting was whether Microsoft would be able to dethrone Sony as the top dogs of the console business.

There were fears that Microsoft might dominate the market like they did with Windows. At first the Xbox didn't do too well, and lack of good games damaged its reputation. It was an accepted fact that the Xbox was superior to the competition in terms of hardware, but many feared that there might be too much emphasis on performance rather than good gameplay. After a torrid first year though, things started to pick up. Better games and the XBOX Live! online gaming service helped it overcome initial criticism to win over customers.

Today, neither the Xbox nor the PS2 have control over the market, although the PS2 is ahead of the Xbox. Microsoft, too, is all ready to launch the XBOX 360, so the Xbox will soon be rendered obsolete.